



Legion gaming phone

Lenovo has introduced a gaming oriented smartphone powered by the Smartdragon 865 Plus chip. <https://digit.in/aug20-61>



New AMD silicon

AMD has announced 12 Ryzen 4000G APUs with Radeon Graphics only available to on the OEM market. <https://digit.in/aug20-62>

Sony WF-SP800N

A host of premium features for under 20K

After waiting inordinately long to enter the congested true wireless market in India, Sony finally introduced two of its true wireless offerings – the Sony WF-XB700 and the Sony WF-SP800N. The latter is Sony's premium sports true wireless earphones. Let's find out how the true wireless in-ears fared in our review.

Build and design

The Sony WF-SP800N are big, brawny earphones with a charging case to match. The earphones have an oval, elongated design with teardrop-shaped touch panels on the top half of each earbud. The tips of the earphones are angled inwards at a 45-degree angle which aids in getting a secure fit. The earphones are quite lightweight and stayed put during jogging and walking. However, some high-intensity workouts can cause them to come loose slightly. The WF-SP800N also comes with wear detection sensors on the buds that automatically pause music when the buds are taken out of the ears.

The matte-textured, plastic charging case feels mediocre in hand and the insides of the case feel quite 'plasticky'. However, the case is quite robust and the magnets within it are extremely strong. The case also does bulge out of pockets due to its larger size.

Features

The Sony WF-SP800N comes packing an array of premium features. The first one is Active Noise Cancellation. Unfortunately, Sony's QN1e processor is absent, which does lower the quality of noise cancellation. The ANC on these earphones is effective at diminishing constant, low-end sounds such as ACs, however, it does have a hard time subsiding erratic, high-pitched sounds.



BUILD AND DESIGN.....68
FEATURES.....86
PERFORMANCE.....77
VALUE.....70

ANC aside, the earphones also come with an Ambient Sound Mode that enhances external sounds.

The accompanying Sony app has a nifty feature called Adaptive Sound Control. Utilising AI capabilities, your current activity is determined – Staying,

Walking, Running or Travelling, and then the ambient sound settings are adjusted accordingly. The app also offers a customisable EQ and the ability to customise touch controls.

The Sony WF-SP800N also comes with an IP55 dust and water-resistant rating. The only missing feature is wireless charging for the case.

Sound quality

The Sony WF-SP800N carries the 'Extra Bass' branding on the box. The warm sound profile does hold that branding up. The bass notes are slightly emphasised while the mids remain largely neutral apart from a small dip in the upper mids. The treble is slightly underemphasised, although there are some peaks in this frequency range as well. Overall, the 6mm drivers deliver well-balanced sound with energetic bass response, which suits an array of genres pretty well. Tracks such as *Another One Bites the Dust* by Queen pumps out the bass kicks with substantial low-end drive and attack. The depth of the bass doesn't take away from the clarity of mid-range vocals. The positioning cues on the earphones are brilliant

with adequate channel separation. Sporting Bluetooth v5.0, the earphones are not at all prone to lags and skips in audio and there's very little noticeable latency. One of the few gripes we have is the lack of aptX and Sony's

LDAC codec, which does negatively impact the detail in the mids and highs.

Battery life and microphone

The battery life of these earphones is pretty good. You get 9 hours of playtime with ANC on and 13 hours with ANC off, on the earphones alone in a single charge. With mixed ANC usage, we managed to squeeze out about 10 and a half hours playback from the earphones alone. The battery life of charging case is where we were disappointed. The massive case can only charge the earphones one time over.

The microphone on these earphones does a pretty decent job at making calls. The receiver on the other end could hear our voice pretty well, although sometimes it did sound a tad muffled. However, the microphone does pick up a fair bit of background sounds which does hamper the overall quality of calls.

Bottomline

The Sony WF-SP800N is a superb addition to the TWS audio segment, offering ANC and other premium features at a sub-20K price point. The sound quality is pretty balanced, and the battery life on the earbuds is pretty good. However, if you prefer more minimalist-looking audio products, these may not be the right choice.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, Dynamic | DRIVER: 6mm Neodymium | WATERPROOF: IP55 (Headset only) | BATTERY CHARGE TIME: Approx. 2.5 Hours | BATTERY LIFE (MUSIC): Max. 9 hours (NC ON), Max. 13 hours (NC OFF) | BATTERY LIFE IN CHARGING CASE: Max. 9 hours (NC), Max. 13 hours (NC OFF) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | EFFECTIVE RANGE: Line of sight approx. 10 m | SUPPORTED AUDIO FORMATS: SBC, AAC | NOISE CANCELLING: Yes | WEIGHT: Approx. 59 g | CHARGING: USB Type-C

CONTACT

SONY INDIA | PHONE: Web form | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.sony.co.in/>